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**RULE OF THUMB** Women voters at a polling booth in Outer Delhi, Jan. 1952; below, voting in progress at Ghaziabad, UP, during the 2019 LS elections

# DANCE OF DEMOCRACY

**At times met with too little trust** and at times with too much, the Indian political party presents a stained mirror to the demotic will

*By* ***Kaushik Deka***



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

***Democracy has thrived in India*** amidst a competition between two models. Formally, it's a multi-party democracy: the power to administer the Union, as also the states that compose it, is attained via a first-past-the-post system of elections. But an implicit tendency to unipolarity/bipolarity—with national parties forming its core—marks its genetic code too. This was visible from the first general election of 1952, swept